

AI TOOLS THAT WORK

3 Examples of Using AI in Real Scenarios

A trip-prep story for US travelers. Three small jobs, real public sources, real AI tests. No coding.

Tested October 3, 2026

Meet Maya

Maya has a flight on Friday, a pair of headphones she does not love, and a bag she has never measured. It is Wednesday night.

She has three loose ends. Is her ID good enough for the airport? Will her bag fit? Can she still return the headphones she bought twelve days ago?

She will not ask an AI to decide anything for her. She will ask it to read rules she pasted in, and then she will check the answers herself. That small habit is the whole guide.

Maya's three steps

1. Find the real rule. Copy only the parts you need.
2. Paste the rule, add your situation, and say what not to invent.
3. Check every number and exception against the source.

The rules and the AI answers are real. Maya and her items are made up. She never actually flew, returned or measured anything.

How I tested

I used a free public chat demo, with no account and no payment: the Qwen3 demo on Hugging Face

(huggingface.co/spaces/Qwen/Qwen3-Demo), model shown as Qwen3-235B-A22B.

On October 3, 2026 I pasted the prompts from this guide into the demo and kept what came back. That was five chats: the ID check (twice), the bag check and the return check (twice), plus one plain-text repair follow-up. Only public facts went in. I read each source page myself and compared it with each answer.

The demo's "Thinking" switch was hard to read on screen, so I note what each answer showed. The bag check and the first ID check showed no thinking step. The others did.

Keep it private. This is a public demo. Never paste boarding passes, receipts with your name, ID numbers, or card details.

One tool, one day. This is not a ranking of AI tools.

Is my ID ready?

Maya's license was renewed last month. She thinks it is the newer kind, but she is not sure. Before she worries, she opens the TSA page for acceptable IDs.

What TSA's page says (checked October 3, 2026)

- Adults 18 and older must show valid ID at the checkpoint.
- REAL ID licenses, passports, passport cards and some other IDs are accepted.
- Since May 7, 2025, state IDs that are not REAL ID compliant are not accepted.
- A temporary driver's license is not acceptable.
- Expired ID is accepted up to two years after expiration.
- Under 18 does not need ID for domestic flights.
- Without acceptable ID, you can pay 45 dollars to try TSA ConfirmID. TSA says it may not be able to verify you.

Source: tsa.gov/travel/security-screening/identification.
TSA says the list can change without notice.

I pasted those facts into the chat and gave it four example travelers to sort.

What the AI said about IDs

The good news. It got the expired passport right: 14 months old is inside the two-year window. It said a 16-year-old needs no ID, and to bring the real license, not the temporary paper one.

What needed fixing

- I said the license's REAL ID status was not confirmed. The AI called it "NOT REAL ID-compliant". That is a different claim.
- It added a tip I never gave it: "look for the star symbol". Not in the source I supplied.
- The demo turned the 45 dollars into broken red text, so the amount vanished.

The repair. I reran with extra lines: say "unconfirmed" when unconfirmed, add nothing outside the facts, no dollar signs.

The result. The star tip was gone and the amount displayed. Scenario A now said to confirm with the DMV. But its heading still read "non-REAL ID state license". Better, not perfect.

Takeaway: AI can tidy rules, but may turn "unconfirmed" into "no". Read the headings too.

CHAPTER 2

Will my bag fit?

ID sorted, Maya looks at her bag. It says "carry-on" on the tag, but that is a store's word, not the airline's. She opens Delta's carry-on page.

What Delta's page says (checked October 3, 2026)

- One carry-on bag and one personal item, free.
- Personal item fits under the seat.
- Carry-on: each side no more than 22 x 14 x 9 inches.
- Length + width + height no more than 45 inches.

- Measurements include handles and wheels.
- If it will not fit, staff can check it at the gate.
- On Delta Connection flights, only personal items fit on board. The page words this two ways: once for all Connection flights, once for planes with 50 seats or fewer. Some carry-ons get gate-checked free.

Source: delta.com/us/en/baggage/carry-on-baggage. Other airlines, and partner flights, can differ.

The trick: a bag can pass one rule and fail the other. So I asked the AI to show its arithmetic for four example bags.

What the AI said about bags

A. Roller 21 x 14 x 9 (inches)

Sum: 44

My check: Fits

AI said: Fits

B. Roller 20 x 15 x 10 (inches)

Sum: 45

My check: Too wide and too tall

AI said: Does not fit

C. Duffel 22 x 14 x 9 (inches)

Sum: 45

My check: Fits, right at the limit

AI said: Fits

D. Roller 21 x 14 x 9 on a Delta Connection flight (I gave no seat count)

Sum: 44

My check: Personal item only per the page;
confirm plane size

AI said: Does not meet; gate check free. It
added "50 seats or less" itself.

Verdicts A to C matched my own check. D matched the page's wording, with a caveat. It caught bag B: total fine (45), two sides too big.

Small things to watch

- For A and C it said "bring it on board". The rule does not promise that.

Takeaway: In this test, AI helped compare the numbers. Still check the airline and measure the real bag.

CHAPTER 3

Can I still return these?

Last, the headphones. Maya got them twelve days ago. Unopened would be easiest, but she did open them. She finds Best Buy's return policy.

What the policy says (checked October 3, 2026)

- The clock starts the day you receive the item.
- Most products: 15 days. My Best Buy Plus or Total members: 60 days.
- Phones and other cellular devices: 14 days for everyone.

- Restocking fee: 15% of price on cameras, drones, camcorders and projectors. 45 dollars on activatable devices.
- No fee if unopened, or if bought in AL, CO, HI, IA, MS, OH, OK or SC.
- Some things cannot be returned once opened, such as LEGO sets and batteries.
- Items must be in like-new condition.

Source: [bestbuy.com return and exchange policy page](https://www.bestbuy.com/return-and-exchange-policy). Policies change; check your own order.

I asked the AI to test six example cases. Money is involved, so she wants the arithmetic in the answer.

What the AI said about returns

Unopened headphones, standard, day 12

My check: Eligible

AI said: Eligible

Same, day 20

My check: Past 15 days

AI said: Not eligible

Same, Plus member, day 20

My check: Eligible (60 days)

AI said: Eligible

Opened LEGO set

My check: Not returnable opened

AI said: Not eligible

Opened 400-dollar camera, Texas, day 10

My check: Eligible, fee 60 dollars

AI said: Eligible, fee 60 dollars

Same camera, Ohio

My check: Eligible, no fee

AI said: Eligible, 0 fee

Every verdict was right in both runs. So was the fee: 15% of 400 is 60.

But the screen was a mess

In both runs, parts of the answer turned into unreadable symbols, likely from dollar signs the demo treats as math. One case could not be read at all.

The repair. I asked for plain text on the four broken cases. It replied in 9.9 seconds, clean and correct.

Takeaway: a right answer you cannot read is no use. Ask for plain text.

Copy this: ID check

This is the improved version I tested. Swap in your own facts from the official page. Do not paste private details.

I'm planning a domestic US flight and want a plain-English ID check. Use only these facts from the TSA page <https://www.tsa.gov/travel/security-screening/identification> (checked October 3, 2026): [paste the facts you copied].

Scenarios: [describe each traveler in one line].

For each scenario say what the stated rule means, the next safe step, and what to confirm. Do not guarantee boarding, invent fees, or fill in rules not

given. End with a five-item checklist.

Also: if a fact is unconfirmed, say it is unconfirmed rather than saying it fails. Do not add any detail that is not in my facts.

Plain text, no dollar signs.

Copy this: bag check

Make a packing check for an adult flying [airline] within the US, based only on this excerpt from [page link] (checked [date]): [paste the size and weight rules].

Scenarios, all inches, handles and wheels included: [list each bag].

For each scenario give meets / does not meet the stated rule, show the arithmetic, and give the next safe step. Do not invent a fee, assume a bag can be squeezed, or book anything. Finish with a five-item checklist.

Copy this: return check

Turn this excerpt of [store]'s public return policy into a plain-English return checklist. I am exploring scenarios, not making a purchase or return. Source [page link] (checked [date]): [paste the time limits, fees and exclusions. Write money as "45 dollars", not with a dollar sign].

Scenarios, all hypothetical: [list each item, when you got it, and where you bought it].

For each scenario say whether it fits the stated rule, with the dollar amount of any fee, and the next step. Do not guarantee acceptance or invent exceptions. Add three questions to ask the store if anything is unclear.

If the answer looks broken

Parts of your last answer displayed as garbled symbols. Please redo [the broken parts] only. Plain text, one short line per item. Do not use dollar signs, bold, bullets or math formatting.

Tip: if you are on a phone, send the prompt in one paste, then scroll the answer slowly. Long answers can be easy to skim past.

Your turn

Here is the pattern to reuse:

Using only the facts below, make [one result]. Keep numbers and exceptions. Say what is missing. Do not invent costs or make decisions for me. [Paste public facts.]

Before you act on any answer

- Does every number match the official page?
- Is every exception still there?
- Did "unconfirmed" or "may" turn into "no" or "will"?
- Is anything in the answer that was not in your facts?
- Can you read it? If not, ask for plain text.

What I did and did not test

Tested: five real chats and one follow-up in one public demo on October 3, 2026, using real TSA, Delta and Best Buy pages and made-up example travelers and items.

Not tested: a real flight, ID check, bag measurement, store return or refund. Repeat runs, or any other AI app. Other days may give different answers.

Sources: tsa.gov/travel/security-screening/identification · delta.com/us/en/baggage/carry-on-baggage · [bestbuy.com return and exchange policy](https://bestbuy.com/return-and-exchange-policy) · huggingface.co/spaces/Qwen/Qwen3-Demo. Not endorsed by any named company.

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Feedback: aitoolsthatwork@atomicmail.io